

Ed - Hearing Support Research

Notes for the long-running conversation with my father Ed in Scranton, who is 74 and refuses hearing aids. Goal is a gentle path to something that helps, not a fight. Family health context only, kept within the family. Updated October 2026.

Where Ed Stands

- Flatly against traditional hearing aids - cost, stigma, and stubbornness in roughly that order.
- The Sunday 19:00 call is harder than it used to be; he misses the quieter half of sentences.
- Television volume is up, and he is withdrawing from group conversation.

Options To Raise Gently

- Over-the-counter hearing aids - far cheaper than the clinic route, worth a low-pressure trial.
- An amplified landline phone - directly fixes the Sunday call, small ask, easy win.
- A TV listening device that does not need him to wear much.
- A baseline hearing check, framed as routine, not as a verdict.

Approach

Lead with the amplified phone since it solves the call we both value. Do not push the aids. Loop Nicole on the family-schedule side, not Ed's medical detail beyond what is relevant to him. Revisit each Scranton visit.